In ASP.NET Core, you can use the `IHostedService` interface to run tasks in the background. Classes that implement this interface are started when your application starts, shortly after your application starts handling requests, and they are stopped shortly before your application is stopped. This provides the hooks you need to perform most tasks.

NOTE Even the default ASP.NET Core server, Kestrel, runs as an `IHosted-Service`. In one sense, almost everything in an ASP.NET Core app is a background task.

In this section you'll see how to use the `IHostedService` to create a background task that runs continuously throughout the lifetime of your app. This could be used for many things, but in the next section you'll see how to use it to populate a simple cache. You'll also learn how to use services with a scoped lifetime in your singleton background tasks by managing container scopes yourself.

34.1.1 Running background tasks on a timer

In this section you'll learn how to create a background task that runs periodically on a timer throughout the lifetime of your app. Running background tasks can be useful for many reasons, such as scheduling work to be performed later or performing work in advance.

In chapter 33 we used `IHttpClientFactory` and a typed client to call a third-party service to retrieve the current exchange rate between various currencies and returned them in an API endpoint, as shown in the following listing.

Listing 34.1 Using a typed client to return exchange rates from a third-party service